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CONSENT TO CAESAREAN SECTION

is indicated for the following condition: _____

A Caesarean Section is:

An operation to remove the baby from the uterus. This is done by a cut in the lower abdomen, followed by a cut in the uterus. The doctor then brings out the baby. Occasionally, forceps may be needed to help the baby's birth through the abdominal wound out of the uterus.

The anaesthetic of choice is a spinal block, achieved by injecting drugs through a needle in the epidural space.

Risks of a Caesarean Section:

There are risks and complications with this procedure. They include, but are not limited to, the following:

Common risks and Complications (> 5%) include:

- ♦ **Infection** in the operation site or pelvis, or urinary tract. Treatment may be wound dressings and/or antibiotics.
- ♦ **Bleeding** could occur and may require a return to the operating room. Bleeding is more common if you have been taking blood-thinning drugs such as Warfarin, Aspirin, and Clopidogrel.
- ♦ The uterus may not contract properly after the operation. This can lead to **excess vaginal bleeding**, which is treated with hormone injection/s to contract the uterus. **In severe cases, it may be necessary to remove the uterus, preventing future pregnancies.**
- ♦ Adhesions (bands of scar tissue) may form and cause bowel obstruction. This can be a short-term or a long-term complication and may need further surgery.
- ♦ **Increased risk in obese people** for wound infection, chest infection, heart and lung complications, and thrombosis.

Uncommon risks and complications (1 – 5%) include:

- ♦ Small areas of the lung can collapse, increasing the risk of chest infection. This may need antibiotics and physiotherapy.
- ♦ **Minor skin cut/s to the baby**, more common in breech births when the baby's bottom is against the wall of the uterus. The baby's bottom, face or body may be cut when the uterus is cut. This usually heals quickly, treated with a band-aid.
- ♦ **Injury to other organs** such as the ureter/s (tube leading from the kidney to the bladder), bladder or bowel. Further surgery will be needed to repair the injuries.
- ♦ **The wound may not heal normally.** The scar can be thickened and red and may be painful. This is permanent and can be disfiguring.
- ♦ A heart attack or stroke could occur due to the strain on the heart.
- ♦ **Blood clot in the leg (DVT)** causing pain and swelling. In rare cases, part of the clot may break off and go to the lungs, which could be fatal.
- ♦ The **scar may rupture (burst) in future pregnancies or during labour.** The risk is highest if the cut is made down the uterus rather than across the lower part of the uterus. Scar rupture can be fatal or lead to hysterectomy as a life-saving measure.



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Rare risks and Complications (<1%) include:

- ♦ For future pregnancies, there is a slightly higher risk of placenta previa. (The afterbirth lies across the lower part of the womb.) This can cause significant blood loss, and the placenta may invade surrounding organs, such as the bladder. A blood transfusion may be needed. Removal of the uterus and repair of the bladder and other organs may be required. This is a potentially life-threatening condition.
- ♦ Severe bleeding from large blood vessels about the uterus, which will need emergency surgery to repair the damaged blood vessels. A blood transfusion may be required to replace blood loss. Rarely, in severe cases, the uterus may have to be removed, stopping future pregnancies.
- ♦ Poor wound healing and the wound may burst open, which may require long-term wound care with dressings and antibiotics, or a hernia, i.e. rupture can form in the long term. This may require further surgery for repair.

Patient consent:

I acknowledge that the doctor has explained:

- ♦ my medical condition and the proposed procedure, including additional treatment if the doctor finds something unexpected. I understand the risks, including those specific to me.
- ♦ The anaesthetic required for this procedure. I understand the risks, including those specific to me.
- ♦ other relevant procedure/treatment options and their associated risks.
- ♦ my prognosis and the risks of not having the procedure.
- ♦ No guarantee has been made that the procedure will improve my condition, even though it has been carried out with due professional care.
- ♦ The procedure may include a blood transfusion.
- ♦ tissues and blood may be removed and could be used for diagnosis or management of my condition, stored and disposed of sensitively by the hospital.
- ♦ If immediate life-threatening events happen during the procedure, they will be treated with due care.
- ♦ I was able to ask questions and raise concerns with the doctor about my condition, the proposed procedure and its risks, and my treatment options. My questions and concerns have been discussed and answered to my satisfaction.

Type text here

I, Elaine Jane Salinas request and consent to the above procedure.

2026/06/27

Date

Patient Signature

Dr. J Potgieter Signature